MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Infrastructure Engineering | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

Wroclaw, Poland | marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused largely on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral environments used by three product teams. Hands-on experience with Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments, plus personal experience building a k3s homelab and provisioning Hetzner VPS infrastructure with Terraform. Known for improving pipeline performance, documenting technical workflows and working across QA, product and development teams. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam; not yet certified.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD
Containers and Linux: Kubernetes (namespace-level work; k3s homelab), Linux
Monitoring and observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki
Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Databases and tools: PostgreSQL, Git, GitLab API
Cloud exposure: Hetzner VPS; AWS free-tier learning (EC2 and S3 basics)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments for applications, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed through GitLab CI using Helm to the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and collected CI test results into PostgreSQL for Grafana dashboards.
- Wrote an internal guide to how the CI system works, now used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Implemented temporary environments for each merge request, including the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed with Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature review and end-to-end testing.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end testing into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.

- Helped teams identify leading flaky tests; the flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the main offenders.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | Studying; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet certified)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)